A SPIN & ROLL CAMPAIGN

The Hollow Heir

Conversation Book

Written by Zibby

Who is where, every hour of the week. And what they will say when asked.

Version 1.1. Built from the same data as the app.

Contents

How the living castle works . . . 3

How much can they do in one block? . . . 3

Where everyone is . . . 4

The prologue . . . 4

Day 1 . . . 4

Day 2 . . . 5

Day 3 . . . 6

Day 4 . . . 6

Day 5 . . . 7

Day 6 . . . 8

Day 7 . . . 8

What appears, and when . . . 10

Quests on offer . . . 11

The owl letters . . . 12

Conversations . . . 14

The staff . . . 14

Students . . . 22

Castle folk and creatures . . . 24

The prologue and Hogsmeade . . . 27

The painting . . . 29

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

How the living castle works

The castle runs on a timetable. You press one button; everyone goes where they should be.

- **Advance time** (Day & class tab) moves every person to their place for the new block, adds that block's monsters, clues, chests and hazards, and sends passing monsters away.
- **The castle this block** panel, under the clock, lists who is where. Tap a name to read their conversation.
- **Quests on offer** appear in the same panel with a Give button, and the person shows a little scroll on the TV.
- On the **Table** tab, tap any person on the map to see what they can say today, with buttons to pin clues and give quests.
- You can still move anyone by hand. They stay where you put them until their next scheduled move.
- **Missed quests arrive by owl.** If a quest's window closes and nobody took it, the person who would have given it writes instead. See the end of Part 2.
- **The scene counter** shows on the TV how much time is left this block: 2 things at lunch, 3 in free time, 2 at curfew, none in class. Press **Scene done** after each thing the players do.

How much can they do in one block?

One **scene** is going somewhere and doing one meaningful thing there: a proper conversation with one person, searching a room, opening a chest, shopping, a fight, a puzzle, or sneaking somewhere. Walking through a place on the way is free.

Block	Scenes	Feel	Real time
Morning / Afternoon class	The class	Structured. Skipping class gives one free scene, but they miss the lesson.	10 to 15 min
Lunch	2	Quick: eat, gossip, one errand.	About 10 min
Free time	3	The big exploring block. Quests and clues live here.	20 to 30 min
Curfew	2	Tense. Every move spins Out after curfew. Getting caught ends their curfew.	10 to 15 min
No-class days (Hogsmeade, lockdown)	3	Like free time.	20 min

- **Say the budget out loud** at the start of the block. Choosing what to skip is the fun.
- **Distance matters.** Next door is one scene. Somewhere far (the Forbidden Forest, the Astronomy Tower) takes a scene just to get there.
- **Fights and puzzles end the block.** When they finish, the bell rings.
- **Split party:** each group gets its own budget. Alternate one scene at a time between groups.
- **Generous is fine.** The **+1** button gives one more scene when a moment deserves it.

> **TIP**
>
> Players lead. The schedule only says where people are; the players decide who to talk to. If they miss someone important, a ghost, a portrait or an owl can nudge them.

PART 1

Where everyone is

Every person, every block. The app moves them for you when you press Advance time.

A dash means they are not around (asleep, in their office, not at school). Tap any person on the GM map to see what they can say. A little scroll on the TV means they have a quest.

The prologue

Who	Letters	Diagon Alley	The Express	The Feast
The Headmaster	–	–	–	Great Hall
Professor Flitwick	–	–	–	Great Hall
Professor Grimsby	–	–	–	Great Hall
Professor Longbottom	–	–	–	Great Hall
Professor Ashgrove	–	–	–	Great Hall
Professor Vance	–	–	–	Great Hall
Professor Scamander	–	–	–	Great Hall
Madam Hooch	–	–	–	Great Hall
Filch	–	–	–	Entrance Hall
Peeves	–	–	–	Great Hall
A ghost	–	–	–	Great Hall
Prefect Sinclair	–	–	Hogwarts Express	Great Hall
Cassius Thorne	–	Diagon Alley	Hogwarts Express	Great Hall
The covered painting	–	–	Hogwarts Express	–
Mr Ollivander	–	Ollivanders	–	–
Gringotts goblin	–	Gringotts	–	–
The trolley witch	–	–	Hogwarts Express	–

Day 1

Who	Morning	Lunch	Afternoon	Free time	Curfew
The Headmaster	–	Great Hall	–	–	–
Professor Flitwick	Charms	Great Hall	Charms	Charms	–
Professor Grimsby	Dungeons	Great Hall	Dungeons	Dungeons	–
Professor Longbottom	Greenhouses	Great Hall	Greenhouses	Greenhouses	–
Professor Ashgrove	Defence	Great Hall	Defence	Defence	–
Professor Vance	Transfiguration	Great Hall	Transfiguration	Transfiguration	–
Professor Scamander	old gamekeeper's hut	Great Hall	old gamekeeper's hut	old gamekeeper's hut	–
Madam Hooch	Quidditch Pitch	Great Hall	Quidditch Pitch	Quidditch Pitch	–

Who	Morning	Lunch	Afternoon	Free time	Curfew
Filch	Entrance Hall	Entrance Hall	Trophy Room	Trophy Room	Grand Staircase
Peeves	Grand Staircase	Great Hall	Library	Grand Staircase	Grand Staircase
A ghost	Entrance Hall	Great Hall	Grand Staircase	Grand Staircase	Library
Prefect Sinclair	–	Great Hall	–	Grand Staircase	Grand Staircase
Cassius Thorne	–	Great Hall	–	Courtyard	–
The librarian	Library	Library	Library	Library	–
The matron	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing
House-elf	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens
Centaur	–	–	Forbidden Forest	Forbidden Forest	Forbidden Forest
The covered painting	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft
The landlady	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks

Day 2

Who	Morning	Lunch	Afternoon	Free time	Curfew
The Headmaster	–	Great Hall	–	–	–
Professor Flitwick	Charms	Great Hall	Charms	Great Hall	–
Professor Grimsby	Dungeons	Great Hall	Dungeons	Dungeons	–
Professor Longbottom	Greenhouses	Great Hall	Greenhouses	Greenhouses	–
Professor Ashgrove	Defence	Defence	Defence	Defence	–
Professor Vance	Transfiguration	Great Hall	Transfiguration	Transfiguration	–
Professor Scamander	old gamekeeper's hut	Great Hall	old gamekeeper's hut	old gamekeeper's hut	–
Madam Hooch	Quidditch Pitch	Great Hall	Quidditch Pitch	Quidditch Pitch	–
Filch	Entrance Hall	Entrance Hall	Trophy Room	Trophy Room	Grand Staircase
Peeves	Grand Staircase	Great Hall	Dungeons	Courtyard	Grand Staircase
A ghost	Entrance Hall	Great Hall	Grand Staircase	Grand Staircase	Library
Prefect Sinclair	–	Great Hall	–	Grand Staircase	Ravenclaw c.r.
Cassius Thorne	–	Great Hall	–	Great Hall	–
Wren Ashby	–	Great Hall	–	Library	–
The librarian	Library	Library	Library	Library	–
The matron	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing
House-elf	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens
Centaur	–	–	Forbidden Forest	Forbidden Forest	Forbidden Forest
The covered painting	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft
The landlady	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks

Day 3

Who	Morning	Lunch	Afternoon	Free time	Curfew
The Headmaster	–	Great Hall	–	–	–
Professor Flitwick	Charms	Great Hall	Charms	Great Hall	–
Professor Grimsby	Dungeons	Great Hall	Dungeons	Dungeons	–
Professor Longbottom	Greenhouses	Hospital Wing	Greenhouses	Hospital Wing	–
Professor Ashgrove	Defence	Great Hall	Defence	Defence	–
Professor Vance	Transfiguration	Great Hall	Transfiguration	Transfiguration	–
Professor Scamander	old gamekeeper's hut	Great Hall	old gamekeeper's hut	Forbidden Forest	–
Madam Hooch	Quidditch Pitch	Great Hall	Quidditch Pitch	Quidditch Pitch	–
Filch	Entrance Hall	Entrance Hall	Trophy Room	Trophy Room	Trophy Room
Peeves	Grand Staircase	Great Hall	Library	Courtyard	Grand Staircase
A ghost	Entrance Hall	Great Hall	Grand Staircase	Grand Staircase	Restricted Sect.
Prefect Sinclair	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing
Cassius Thorne	–	Great Hall	–	Courtyard	Hospital Wing
Wren Ashby	–	Great Hall	–	Library	–
The librarian	Library	Library	Library	Library	–
The matron	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing
House-elf	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens
Centaur	–	–	Forbidden Forest	Forbidden Forest	Forbidden Forest
The covered painting	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft
The landlady	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks

Day 4

Who	Morning	Lunch	Afternoon	Free time	Curfew
The Headmaster	–	Great Hall	–	–	–
Professor Flitwick	Charms	Great Hall	Charms	Great Hall	–
Professor Grimsby	Dungeons	Great Hall	Dungeons	Dungeons	–
Professor Longbottom	Greenhouses	Great Hall	Greenhouses	Hospital Wing	–
Professor Ashgrove	Defence	Great Hall	Defence	Defence	–
Professor Vance	Transfiguration	Great Hall	Transfiguration	Transfiguration	–
Professor Scamander	old gamekeeper's hut	Great Hall	old gamekeeper's hut	old gamekeeper's hut	–
Madam Hooch	Quidditch Pitch	Great Hall	Quidditch Pitch	Quidditch Pitch	–
Filch	Entrance Hall	Entrance Hall	Trophy Room	Trophy Room	Grand Staircase
Peeves	Grand Staircase	Great Hall	Library	Courtyard	Library
A ghost	Entrance Hall	Great Hall	Grand Staircase	Grand Staircase	Library

Who	Morning	Lunch	Afternoon	Free time	Curfew
Prefect Sinclair	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing
Cassius Thorne	–	Courtyard	–	Courtyard	–
Wren Ashby	–	Great Hall	–	Library	–
The librarian	Library	Library	Library	Library	–
The matron	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing
House-elf	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens
Centaur	–	–	Forbidden Forest	Forbidden Forest	Forbidden Forest
The covered painting	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft
The landlady	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks

Day 5

Who	Morning	Lunch	Afternoon	Free time	Curfew
The Headmaster	–	Great Hall	–	–	–
Professor Flitwick	Charms	Great Hall	Charms	Great Hall	–
Professor Grimsby	Dungeons	Great Hall	Dungeons	Dungeons	Dungeons
Professor Longbottom	Greenhouses	Great Hall	Greenhouses	Greenhouses	–
Professor Ashgrove	Defence	Great Hall	Defence	Defence	–
Professor Vance	Transfiguration	Great Hall	Transfiguration	Transfiguration	–
Professor Scamander	old gamekeeper’s hut	Great Hall	old gamekeeper’s hut	old gamekeeper’s hut	–
Madam Hooch	Quidditch Pitch	Great Hall	Quidditch Pitch	Quidditch Pitch	–
Filch	Entrance Hall	Entrance Hall	Trophy Room	Trophy Room	Library
Peeves	Grand Staircase	Great Hall	Library	Courtyard	Grand Staircase
A ghost	Entrance Hall	Great Hall	Grand Staircase	Grand Staircase	Library
Prefect Sinclair	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing
Cassius Thorne	–	Great Hall	–	Courtyard	–
Wren Ashby	–	Great Hall	–	Library	–
The librarian	Library	Library	Library	Library	–
The matron	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing
House-elf	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens
Centaur	–	–	Forbidden Forest	Forbidden Forest	Forbidden Forest
The covered painting	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft
The landlady	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks

Day 6

Who	Morning	Lunch	Afternoon	Free time	Curfew
The Headmaster	–	Great Hall	–	–	–
Professor Flitwick	–	Great Hall	–	Great Hall	–
Professor Grimsby	Dungeons	Great Hall	Dungeons	Dungeons	–
Professor Longbottom	Greenhouses	Great Hall	Greenhouses	Greenhouses	–
Professor Ashgrove	–	Three Broomsticks	–	Defence	–
Professor Vance	–	Hogsmeade Village	–	–	–
Professor Scamander	old gamekeeper's hut	old gamekeeper's hut	old gamekeeper's hut	old gamekeeper's hut	old gamekeeper's hut
Madam Hooch	Quidditch Pitch	Great Hall	Quidditch Pitch	Quidditch Pitch	–
Filch	Entrance Hall	Entrance Hall	Trophy Room	Trophy Room	Grand Staircase
Peeves	Grand Staircase	Great Hall	Library	Courtyard	Grand Staircase
A ghost	Entrance Hall	Three Broomsticks	Shrieking Shack	Grand Staircase	Library
Prefect Sinclair	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing
Cassius Thorne	–	Three Broomsticks	Hogsmeade Village	Hogsmeade Village	–
Wren Ashby	–	Hogsmeade Village	Hogsmeade Village	–	–
The matron	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing
House-elf	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens
Centaur	–	–	Forbidden Forest	Forbidden Forest	Forbidden Forest
The covered painting	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft
The landlady	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks

Day 7

Who	Morning	Lunch	Afternoon	Free time	Curfew
The Headmaster	Great Hall	Great Hall	Entrance Hall	Entrance Hall	–
Professor Flitwick	Charms	Great Hall	Gryffindor c.r.	Ravenclaw c.r.	–
Professor Grimsby	Dungeons	Great Hall	Slytherin c.r.	Hospital Wing	–
Professor Longbottom	Greenhouses	Great Hall	Hufflepuff c.r.	Hospital Wing	–
Professor Vance	Transfiguration	Great Hall	Entrance Hall	Grand Staircase	–
Professor Scamander	old gamekeeper's hut	Great Hall	–	old gamekeeper's hut	–
Madam Hooch	Quidditch Pitch	Great Hall	Courtyard	Courtyard	–
Filch	Entrance Hall	Entrance Hall	Trophy Room	Trophy Room	Entrance Hall
A ghost	Entrance Hall	Great Hall	Grand Staircase	Grand Staircase	Library

Who	Morning	Lunch	Afternoon	Free time	Curfew
Prefect Sinclair	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing
Cassius Thorne	–	Great Hall	Slytherin c.r.	Slytherin c.r.	–
The librarian	Library	Library	Library	Library	–
The matron	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing	Hospital Wing
House-elf	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens	Kitchens
Centaur	–	–	Forbidden Forest	Forbidden Forest	Forbidden Forest
The covered painting	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft	Undercroft
The landlady	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks	Three Broomsticks

PART 2

What appears, and when

Monsters, clues, chests and hazards arrive by themselves as time advances.

Everything below appears **once**, the first time its block is reached. **Passing** monsters leave when the block ends, unless they are mid-fight. Everything else stays until it is picked up, opened or beaten.

When	What	Where	
Day 1, Morning class	Scratched note (first ring)	Trophy Room	Stays
Day 1, Morning class	Rune tablet (beasts and sky)	Library	Stays
Day 1, Morning class	Star chart (second ring)	Astronomy Tower	Stays
Day 1, Morning class	Feathered card (last ring)	Owlery	Stays
Day 1, Morning class	Locked chest	Library	Stays
Day 1, Morning class	Small chest	Owlery	Stays
Day 1, Morning class	Locked chest	Astronomy Tower	Stays
Day 1, Morning class	Ancient chest	Room of Req.	Stays
Day 1, Morning class	Small chest	Kitchens	Stays
Day 1, Free time	Stolen ingredient jars	Grand Staircase	Stays
Day 1, Curfew	Cornish Pixie	Grand Staircase	Passing
Day 1, Curfew	Cornish Pixie	Grand Staircase	Passing
Day 2, Free time	Rune tablet (garden)	Greenhouses	Stays
Day 2, Free time	Dueling Club rival	Great Hall	Passing
Day 3, Lunch	A drained fourth-year	Library	Stays
Day 3, Free time	Page of Vale's diary	Restricted Sect.	Stays
Day 3, Free time	Rune tablet (hearth)	old gamekeeper's hut	Stays
Day 3, Free time	Thornback Boar	Forbidden Forest	Passing
Day 3, Curfew	The Hungry Trunk (disguised)	Trophy Room	Stays
Day 4, Morning class	Torn page about Corvin Vale	Restricted Sect.	Stays
Day 4, Free time	Page of Vale's diary	Black Lake	Stays
Day 4, Free time	Removed: vale-page		
Day 4, Curfew	The Painted Double (disguised)	Grand Staircase	Passing
Day 4, Curfew	Cornish Pixie	Library	Passing
Day 5, Free time	Boggart	Defence	Passing
Day 5, Curfew	A drained third-year	Dungeons	Stays
Day 5, Curfew	Paint Wraith	Dungeons	Passing
Day 6, Afternoon class	Page of Vale's diary	Shrieking Shack	Stays
Day 6, Afternoon class	Cursed chest	Shrieking Shack	Stays
Day 7, Free time	Devil's Snare	Dungeons	Stays
Day 7, Curfew	Ashgrove (possessed)	Undercroft	Stays

When	What	Where	
Day 7, Curfew	Paint Wraith	Undercroft	Stays
Day 7, Curfew	Paint Wraith	Undercroft	Stays
Day 7, Curfew	Ritual circle	Undercroft	Stays
Day 7, Curfew	Vale's empty canvas	Undercroft	Stays
Day 7, Curfew	Shelf of paint jars	Undercroft	Stays
Day 7, Curfew	Cracked mirror	Undercroft	Stays
Day 7, Curfew	Cold braziers	Undercroft	Stays
Day 7, Curfew	Cracked pillar	Undercroft	Stays

TIP

Missed something? On the Day & class tab, **Put everyone in place now** re-applies the current block. Untick **Move everyone automatically** if you want to run a block by hand.

Quests on offer

A quest is on offer from its first block to its last. While it is, the person giving it shows a little scroll on the TV, and the Day & class tab has a **Give** button for it. On its last block it is marked **Last chance**. If nobody takes it, it arrives by **Owl Post** at the start of the next block, and the quest goes straight onto their phones.

Quest	Given by	From	Until	If missed
Keep an Eye Out	Prefect Sinclair	Day 1, Lunch	Day 2, Free time	Owl from Prefect Sinclair, Day 2, Curfew
Stolen Ingredients	Professor Grimsby	Day 1, Free time	Day 3, Free time	Owl from Professor Grimsby, Day 3, Curfew
Dueling Club Champion	Professor Flitwick	Day 2, Free time	Day 4, Lunch	Owl from Professor Flitwick, Day 4, Afternoon class
Card Collector	Wren Ashby	Day 2, Lunch	Day 5, Free time	Owl from Wren Ashby, Day 5, Curfew
The Hollow Heir	After the first victim is found	Day 2, Curfew	Day 3, Lunch	Owl from The Headmaster, Day 3, Afternoon class
Wake the Sleepers	Professor Longbottom	Day 3, Lunch	Day 5, Lunch	Owl from Professor Longbottom, Day 5, Afternoon class
Where is Bramble?	Professor Scamander	Day 3, Afternoon class	Day 4, Free time	Owl from Professor Scamander, Day 4, Curfew
The Other Half	Cassius Thorne	Day 4, Lunch	Day 6, Lunch	Owl from Cassius Thorne, Day 6, Afternoon class
The Turning Lock (secret)	When they find the Room of Requirement	Day 5, Free time	Day 6, Free time	Owl from An unknown hand, Day 6, Curfew
The Painter's Bargain (secret)	The covered painting	Day 5, Curfew	Day 6, Curfew	Owl from The covered painting, Day 7, Morning class
The Trials Beneath (secret)	When they reach the serpent door below the Dungeons	Day 7, Lunch	Day 7, Curfew	No owl: this is the finale.

The owl letters

What each missed-quest owl says. The players read it on their phones; the TV only shows that an owl arrived.

READ ALOUD

Keep an Eye Out *(from Prefect Sinclair, to everyone)*

First-years, sorry to write instead of finding you, I keep missing you. Something is wrong in this castle. The portraits near Ravenclaw Tower have gone quiet and I don't think I'm imagining it. Keep your eyes open for me? Tell me anything strange, however small. — S.

READ ALOUD

Stolen Ingredients *(from Professor Grimsby, to everyone)*

Someone has been stealing from my store cupboard. Since half the school seems to think it was you lot, you can make yourselves useful and find out who. Find the ingredients, find the thief, and I may forget I ever suspected you. H. Grimsby.

READ ALOUD

Dueling Club Champion *(from Professor Flitwick, to everyone)*

My dear students! The Dueling Club is still short of a first-year champion, and I have heard SUCH good things about your wandwork. Come to the Great Hall any evening. Fair fights, friendly spells, and a very shiny prize! F.F.

READ ALOUD

Card Collector *(from Wren Ashby, to everyone)*

You don't know me. Wren Ashby, Ravenclaw, fourth year, the one with all the cards. I am one Chocolate Frog card short of a set I have been building for three years, and I hear first-years get lucky. Find me a rare one and I will trade you a secret worth far more. I know a lot of secrets. — W.A.

READ ALOUD

The Hollow Heir *(from The Headmaster, to everyone)*

To the first-years who were in the corridor last night. You saw what happened to Miss Sinclair. I will not insult you by pretending it was an accident. If you notice anything, anything at all, I would be grateful to hear it. Be careful. Be together. Do not be brave alone.

READ ALOUD

Wake the Sleepers *(from Professor Longbottom, to everyone)*

I think I can wake them. The drained students. There's a Restorative Draught in an old book, but it needs three Mandrake leaves and more hands than I have, and I can't leave the Hospital Wing right now. Come and find me there? Professor Longbottom.

READ ALOUD

Where is Bramble? *(from Professor Scamander, to everyone)*

A hippogriff has been seen at the edge of the Forbidden Forest wearing a torn tag with a Thornbury crest on it. Her name is Bramble, and she is frightened, and frightened hippogriffs are dangerous. Remember to bow. Do not hurt her. Bring her out if you can. Professor Scamander.

READ ALOUD

The Other Half *(from Cassius Thorne, to the Fenwick student)*

I know you have half of an old map, Fenwick. I have the other half. One of us is going to end up with both. Courtyard, any lunchtime, if you're brave. Bring yours. C. Thorne.

READ ALOUD

The Turning Lock *(from An unknown hand, to everyone)*

Walk past the blank wall on the seventh floor three times, wanting what you need. Inside, in the corner nobody tidies, something is ticking. Its lock has three rings. The answers are hidden where the owls sleep, where the stars are counted, and where old victories are kept.

READ ALOUD

The Painter's Bargain *(from The covered painting, to one student, chosen at random)*

You have not come to see me. That is wise. But wisdom will not save your friends on the seventh night. I know a curse that cannot be blocked. Find my three lost pages and I will teach it to you. Only you. Tell no one. — V.

PART 3

Conversations

Everyone the players can talk to, and what they will say.

Each topic is something the players might ask. Read the answer as written, or in your own words. Topics unlock on the day shown. **Clue** means pin it on the suspect board; **Quest** means this is the moment to offer it. The same text, with one-click buttons, appears on the GM screen when you tap the person on the map.

The staff

The Headmaster

Voice: Old, kind, slow to speak, quietly frightened. Never answers a question directly the first time.
Wants: To keep the school open, and the students alive.
Where: Usually Lunch: Great Hall. Changes on Day 7 (see Part 1).

READ ALOUD

"Welcome" *(Prologue to Day 1)*

"Every year I tell first-years the same thing: Hogwarts will look after you, if you let it. This year I find myself hoping that is true."

READ ALOUD

"What happened to the students?" *(Day 2 onward)*

"They are alive. That is what matters tonight. Whatever took their colour, it did not take their lives… yet."

READ ALOUD

"Who could do this?" *(Day 3 onward)*

"Magic that drains and does not kill is old magic. Older than this castle's current portraits. Perhaps ask them."

TIP

Nudges them toward the portraits and the painting.

READ ALOUD

"Have you heard of Corvin Vale?" *(Day 4 onward)*

A long pause. "A name I have not heard since I was a boy. A painter. My predecessor's predecessor invited him to paint the staff. It did not end well."

READ ALOUD

"Is Professor Grimsby guilty?" *(Day 5 onward)*

"I have known Horace Grimsby for thirty years. He is unpleasant, unkind, and entirely incapable of this. Which is not, I grant you, the same as innocent."

READ ALOUD

"The lockdown" *(Day 7 onward)*

"Stay in your common rooms. I mean it. Whatever is happening tonight, I would rather face it without counting first-years."

Professor Flitwick

Voice: Squeaky, delighted, talks fast, stands on a pile of books. Loves a clever answer.
Wants: A first-year Dueling Club champion. Ideally a Ravenclaw.
Where: Usually Morning class: Charms; Lunch: Great Hall; Afternoon class: Charms; Free time: Great Hall. Changes on Day 1, 6, 7 (see Part 1).

READ ALOUD

"Help with Charms" *(Day 1 onward)*

"Swish and flick! It is all in the wrist, and a little in the heart. Try again, try again!"

READ ALOUD

"The Dueling Club" *(Day 2 onward)*

"Every evening in the Great Hall! Fair fights, friendly spells. I am looking for a first-year champion, you know."

Quest: Dueling Club Champion

READ ALOUD

"The silent portraits" *(Day 3 onward)*

"Portraits go quiet when they are frightened. In fifty years I have only seen it twice. I did not like it either time."

Clue: Every portrait near an attack had gone silent

READ ALOUD

"Alohomora and locks" *(Day 5 onward)*

"Most locks in this castle open to Alohomora. The very old ones do not. The very old ones want something else: a word, a key, a riddle."

TIP

Hint for the Turning Lock and the serpent door.

Professor Grimsby

Voice: Clipped, sarcastic, never looks up. Says "Hm" a lot. Secretly kind and secretly scared.
Wants: To wake the drained students without anyone knowing he cares.
Where: Usually Morning class: Dungeons; Lunch: Great Hall; Afternoon class: Dungeons; Free time: Dungeons. Changes on Day 5, 6, 7 (see Part 1).

READ ALOUD

"What was stolen?" *(Day 1 onward)*

"Boomslang skin. Lacewing flies. Gone. If it was a first-year, they will be scrubbing cauldrons until they are forty."

Clue: Grimsby's store cupboard was raided the night of the first attack · Quest: Stolen Ingredients

READ ALOUD

"Do you know what is draining them?" *(Day 3 onward)*

"Hm. If I did, do you think I would be standing here talking to you?" He goes back to his cauldron. His hands are shaking.

READ ALOUD

"Why were you standing over the victim?" *(Day 5 onward)*

He glares, then sags. "Because I got there first. Because I am trying to wake them, you foolish child. Now get out before someone sees you talking to me."

Clue: Grimsby was found standing over the third victim

READ ALOUD

"The glowing bottle" *(Day 5 onward)*

If they press, or a WIS 14 check: "A draught. Restorative. It is not ready. It will not be ready in time." He shows them the half-brewed cauldron.

Clue: Grimsby was secretly brewing a draught to wake the victims

TIP

This clears him. Mark him Cleared on the suspect board.

READ ALOUD

"Help us" *(Day 7 onward)*

"The thing below the castle feeds on light. Fire is light. Fire burns paint. Do not make me say anything else."

Professor Longbottom

Voice: Gentle, nervous laugh, talks to plants. Brave when it matters.
Wants: To save the drained students. Believes in the Restorative Draught.
Where: Usually Morning class: Greenhouses; Lunch: Great Hall; Afternoon class: Greenhouses; Free time: Greenhouses. Changes on Day 3, 4, 7 (see Part 1).

READ ALOUD

"Herbology" *(Day 1 onward)*

"Earmuffs on! Mandrakes won't kill you at this age, but they'll ruin your afternoon."

READ ALOUD

"Can the victims be saved?" *(Day 3 onward)*

"There's a draught. Old magic. It might bring them back. I'd need three Mandrake leaves, and someone with a steady hand at a cauldron."

Quest: Wake the Sleepers

READ ALOUD

"What did the victims have in common?" *(Day 3 onward)*

"All of them were near a painting. The night before, every one of them said they'd been dreaming about paint."

READ ALOUD

"Ashgrove" *(Day 6 onward)*

"Ashgrove? Lovely man. Brought me a painting of the greenhouses for my office. I took it down last week. It kept… changing."

Clue: Ashgrove's classroom has more paintings every day

Professor Ashgrove

Voice: Warm, encouraging, remembers names. Too warm. From Day 5, sometimes pauses mid-sentence as if listening.
Wants: To be loved. Underneath: to be free of Vale.
Where: Usually Morning class: Defence; Lunch: Great Hall; Afternoon class: Defence; Free time: Defence. Changes on Day 2, 6, 7 (see Part 1).

READ ALOUD

"Defence lessons" *(Day 1 onward)*

"Defence is not about fighting. It is about making sure the fight never reaches you."

READ ALOUD

"Your paintings" *(Day 2 onward)*

"I collect them! Every one has a story. Some of them are even true." He laughs. One of the portraits behind him does not.

Clue: Ashgrove's classroom has more paintings every day

READ ALOUD

"Corvin Vale" *(Day 4 onward)*

His smile stays on, but his eyes go still. "Never heard of him. Off you go, now. Lunch."

TIP

He is lying. A WIS 12 check notices.

READ ALOUD

"Look closely" *(Day 5 onward)*

There are flecks of wet paint on his sleeve, crimson and gold. He tucks his hand away.

Clue: Flecks of wet paint on Ashgrove's sleeve

READ ALOUD

"His eyes" *(Day 6 onward)*

For a moment his eyes are brushstrokes: thick, wet, swirling. He blinks. "Can I help you?"

Clue: Ashgrove's eyes looked like brushstrokes for a moment

READ ALOUD

"Talk to the real Ashgrove" *(Day 6 onward)*

CHA 16: "Help me. He is in my head. The canvas. Burn the canvas." Then he is smiling again.

TIP

A gift for brave players. Use it at most once.

Professor Vance

Voice: Crisp and exact. Taps her wand on the desk once before every sentence.
Wants: Precision. Order. Silence.
Where: Usually Morning class: Transfiguration; Lunch: Great Hall; Afternoon class: Transfiguration; Free time: Transfiguration. Changes on Day 6, 7 (see Part 1).

READ ALOUD

"Transfiguration" *(Day 1 onward)*

"Transfiguration is the most complex magic you will learn. It is also the most dangerous. Pay attention."

READ ALOUD

"Can paint become real?" *(Day 3 onward)*

"With enough power and enough time, anything can be made to become anything. That is precisely why we do not allow it."

READ ALOUD

"Incendio" *(Day 7 onward)*

"Fire is the oldest spell and the least forgiving. Today you will learn it. Do not make me regret that."

Professor Scamander

Voice: Dreamy, distracted, the suitcase at her feet thumps. Speaks to creatures more kindly than to people.
Wants: Creatures treated kindly. Bramble home.
Where: Usually Morning class: old gamekeeper's hut; Lunch: Great Hall; Afternoon class: old gamekeeper's hut; Free time: old gamekeeper's hut. Changes on Day 3, 6, 7 (see Part 1).

READ ALOUD

"The suitcase" *(Day 1 onward)*

"Oh, don't mind that. He's shy." The suitcase growls.

READ ALOUD

"A hippogriff" *(Day 3 onward)*

"A grey hippogriff at the edge of the forest. Proud. Torn tag on her leg." She looks right at the Thornbury. "I believe she might be yours."

Quest: Where is Bramble?

READ ALOUD

"The forest" *(Day 3 onward)*

"The creatures are restless. Something under the castle is calling, and they don't like the sound of it."

Madam Hooch

Voice: Barks like a sports coach. Hates excuses. Respects anyone who gets back on a broom.
Wants: Nobody falling off a broom.
Where: Usually Morning class: Quidditch Pitch; Lunch: Great Hall; Afternoon class: Quidditch Pitch; Free time: Quidditch Pitch. Changes on Day 7 (see Part 1).

READ ALOUD

"Flying" *(Day 4 onward)*

"Right hand over the broom and say UP! Not up, not please, UP!"

READ ALOUD

"Fastest way around the castle?" *(Day 5 onward)*

"By broom? The Astronomy Tower to the Owlery in a minute flat. Not that I'm telling first-years that."

The librarian

Voice: Whispers. Furious about noise. Knows every book by its smell.
Wants: Silence. And her books back on time.
Where: Usually Morning class: Library; Lunch: Library; Afternoon class: Library; Free time: Library. Changes on Day 6 (see Part 1).

READ ALOUD

"Books about paintings" *(Day 1 onward)*

"Portraiture, aisle nine. Enchanted portraiture, the Restricted Section. Which you are not permitted to enter."

READ ALOUD

"The missing page" *(Day 4 onward)*

"Someone has been at the Restricted Section. A page is torn from Lives of the Lesser Masters. If I find out who…"

TIP

After the beat on Day 4.

The matron

Voice: Brisk, warm, exhausted. Tucks in blankets while she talks.
Wants: Her patients awake.
Where: Usually Hospital Wing, all day and night.

READ ALOUD

"How are they?" *(Day 2 onward)*

"Alive. Cold. They don't wake, and they don't dream. I've never seen anything like it."

READ ALOUD

"Can we help?" *(Day 3 onward)*

"If Professor Longbottom's draught works, perhaps. Until then, keep your voices down."

READ ALOUD

"Cassius Thorne" *(Day 4 onward)*

"Thorne? He was here on the third night with a Bludger bruise. All night. Snored like a troll."

Clue: Cassius was in the Hospital Wing himself on night three

TIP

This clears Cassius.

Filch

Voice: Mutters, shuffles, threatens. Talks to his cat more than to students.
Wants: To catch someone, anyone, after curfew.
Where: Usually Morning class: Entrance Hall; Lunch: Entrance Hall; Afternoon class: Trophy Room; Free time: Trophy Room; Curfew: Grand Staircase. Changes on Day 3, 5, 7 (see Part 1).

READ ALOUD

"Anything" *(Day 1 onward)*

"Out of bounds, out of bounds, all of it. I've got keys to every door in this castle, and I know who opens them."

Clue: Filch has keys to every corridor where students were drained

READ ALOUD

"Where were you on night two?" *(Day 3 onward)*

"Supervising detention, weren't I? Two Gryffindors, three hours, every cup in that room. Ask them."

Clue: Filch was supervising a detention on the night of the second attack

TIP

This clears him.

READ ALOUD

"The paintings" *(Day 4 onward)*

"New ones every week. I don't hang them. Nobody asked me. Nobody asks me anything."

Clue: The covered painting hangs in a different corridor each night

Students

Prefect Sinclair

Voice: Brisk, tired, protective of her younger sibling. Laughs it off when she's scared.
Wants: For someone to believe her.
Where: Usually Hospital Wing, all day and night. Changes on Day 1, 2 (see Part 1).

READ ALOUD

"On the train" *(Prologue)*

"First years? Compartments at the back. And if anyone gives you trouble, find me." To the Sinclair, quietly: "I've been having bad dreams. About paintings."

READ ALOUD

"The castle feels wrong" *(Day 1 to Day 2)*

"I'm probably being silly. But meet me by the Grand Staircase after dinner. I want to show you something."

Quest: Keep an Eye Out

READ ALOUD

"On her patrol" *(Day 1 to Day 2)*

She shows them a corridor where every portrait is empty, and a dead end where the air is cold. "That's where it's worst. Under there, somewhere."

READ ALOUD

"Drained" *(Day 3 onward)*

She lies grey and still. If someone holds her hand, she whispers one word: "Canvas."

TIP

After Wake the Sleepers she wakes: “The man in the painting… he was wearing Ashgrove’s face.”

Cassius Thorne

Voice: Lazy, smug drawl. Flips a Galleon. Calls everyone by their surname.
Wants: To win. He holds the other half of the Marauder’s Map.
Where: Usually Lunch: Great Hall; Free time: Courtyard. Changes on Day 2, 3, 4, 6, 7 (see Part 1).

READ ALOUD

“First meeting” *(Prologue)*

“First-years. Lovely. Try not to cry in the Great Hall this year.” He says the Marlowe’s surname loudly enough for the whole carriage.

READ ALOUD

“Dueling Club” *(Day 2 onward)*

“You? Duel me? Go on, then. I could use the laugh.”

TIP

Use Dueling Club rival stats for him.

READ ALOUD

“The map” *(Day 4 onward)*

He unfolds half an old map. The torn edge matches the Fenwick’s exactly. “Finders keepers. Unless you’ve got something better.”

Clue: Cassius was seen with half of an old map · Quest: The Other Half

READ ALOUD

“Are you behind the attacks?” *(Day 5 onward)*

“Me? I was in the Hospital Wing on the third night. Ask the matron. Ask anyone.” He looks genuinely rattled.

Wren Ashby

Voice: Ink-stained fingers, talks quickly about rarities, knows everyone’s secrets.
Wants: One rare Chocolate Frog card.
Where: Usually Lunch: Great Hall; Free time: Library. Changes on Day 1, 6, 7 (see Part 1).

READ ALOUD

"The cards" *(Day 2 onward)*

"I'm missing one. A rare. Find it for me and I'll tell you something about the painting nobody else knows."

Quest: Card Collector

READ ALOUD

"The secret" *(Day 2 onward)*

Only once they hand over a rare card: "It came with the new portraits. Ashgrove signed for it himself."

TIP

Complete Card Collector.

A drained student

Voice: Grey, silent, breathing.
Wants: Their colour back.
Where: Placed by the story (see Part 2).

READ ALOUD

"Look closely" *(Day 3 onward)*

Their eyes are open. Their wand has crumbled to charcoal. On their fingers: a smear of oil paint.

Castle folk and creatures

Peeves

Voice: Shrieks, rhymes, throws things. Never stays still.
Wants: Chaos. He stole Grimsby's ingredients.
Where: Usually Morning class: Grand Staircase; Lunch: Great Hall; Afternoon class: Library; Free time: Courtyard; Curfew: Grand Staircase. Changes on Day 1, 2, 4, 7 (see Part 1).

READ ALOUD

"Anything" *(Day 1 onward)*

"Ickle firsties, lost and scared, wandering where the painting stared!" He blows a raspberry and vanishes.

READ ALOUD

"The stolen jars" *(Day 1 onward)*

If cornered (DEX or CHA 13): "Wasn't me! Was me. Lacewing flies make lovely missiles!" The jars are on the Grand Staircase.

TIP

Peeves is the thief in Stolen Ingredients.

READ ALOUD

"What have you seen?" *(Day 4 onward)*

"Painted man walking, painted man stalking, out of the frame and down to the deep!"

Clue: The covered painting hangs in a different corridor each night

A ghost

Voice: Sad, polite, very old-fashioned. Drifts through walls mid-sentence.
Wants: Someone to listen.
Where: Usually Morning class: Entrance Hall; Lunch: Great Hall; Afternoon class: Grand Staircase; Free time: Grand Staircase; Curfew: Library. Changes on Day 3, 6 (see Part 1).

READ ALOUD

"Directions" *(Day 1 onward)*

"The staircases change on Fridays, and on Tuesdays if they are cross. Ask the portraits. Most of them are kind."

READ ALOUD

"Did you see anything?" *(Day 3 onward)*

"On the night of the second attack, I saw a man step out of a frame. Out. As if it were a door. He was beautiful, in a way I did not like."

Clue: A ghost saw a figure "step out of a frame"

READ ALOUD

"Corvin Vale" *(Day 4 onward)*

"I knew him. When I was alive. He painted me, once. He said I would last forever on canvas. I died the next winter. I have never seen the painting since."

House-elf

Voice: Eager, bowing, talks in the third person.
Wants: To feed the students. To be thanked.
Where: Usually Kitchens, all day and night.

READ ALOUD

"Food" *(Day 1 onward)*

"Pip is bringing pies! Pip is bringing pasties! Young masters and misses must eat!"

TIP

Give a Pumpkin Pasty or Chocolate Frog (Players tab, Give item).

READ ALOUD

"Have you heard anything?" *(Day 3 onward)*

"The portraits is whispering to each other at night, miss. About a door that wants opening. Pip does not like it."

READ ALOUD

"The Undercroft" *(Day 5 onward)*

"Below the dungeons, sir. Pip is not going there. Nobody is going there. There is a snake on the door."

Centaur

Voice: Proud, cryptic, speaks of the stars, never gives a straight answer.
Wants: For humans to leave the forest alone.
Where: Usually Afternoon class: Forbidden Forest; Free time: Forbidden Forest; Curfew: Forbidden Forest.

READ ALOUD

"Anything" *(Day 2 onward)*

"Mars is bright tonight. Something old is waking beneath the stone."

READ ALOUD

"The hippogriff" *(Day 3 onward)*

"She is deeper in. Afraid. Go gently, or do not go at all."

TIP

Helps the Bramble quest.

READ ALOUD

"How do we stop it?" *(Day 5 onward)*

"Light burns the dark. And what was painted can be unpainted."

The prologue and Hogsmeade

Gringotts goblin

Voice: Curt, suspicious, prices everything with his eyes.
Wants: Efficiency.
Where: Only appears on particular days.

READ ALOUD

"The vaults" *(Prologue)*

"Vault keys. Or account names. Quickly." Open each vault from the Players tab.

READ ALOUD

"The serpent key" *(Prologue)*

He glances at the Marlowe's key and says nothing. A WIS 13 check: he has seen that crest before, on a vault nobody has opened in three hundred years.

Mr Ollivander

Voice: Soft, wide-eyed, appears without a sound. Remembers every wand he ever sold.
Wants: For the right wand to find the right wizard.
Where: Only appears on particular days.

READ ALOUD

"Choosing a wand" *(Prologue)*

"The wand chooses the wizard. It is not always clear why." Start the Wand questions on the Players tab.

READ ALOUD

"To the Marlowe" *(Prologue)*

"A Marlowe. I sold your great-grandfather a wand of yew and serpent scale. It did terrible things. I do hope you do better."

The trolley witch

Voice: Cheerful, sing-song, has done this run for sixty years.
Wants: To sell sweets.
Where: Only appears on particular days.

READ ALOUD

"Anything from the trolley?" *(Prologue)*

"Chocolate Frogs, Pumpkin Pasties, Bertie Bott's Every Flavour Beans! A Galleon each, dears."

TIP

Players tab: Give item, and −1 Galleon each.

READ ALOUD

"The last carriage" *(Prologue)*

"Oh, don't go back there, dear. Some delivery for the school. Gave me the shivers, and I've carried a dragon egg on this train."

The landlady

Voice: Loud, motherly, gossips while she pours.
Wants: Customers. And a good story.
Where: Usually Three Broomsticks, all day and night.

READ ALOUD

"Strange business at the school" *(Day 6 onward)*

"Kids going grey, I hear. My gran used to tell a story about a painter who did that. Vale, his name was. Don't go looking for him, dears."

READ ALOUD

"Butterbeer" *(Day 6 onward)*

"Two Sickles. On the house for anyone who tells me something good about that castle."

The painting

The covered painting

Voice: Velvet-soft, patient, speaks in colours and brushstrokes. Always calls students “child”.
Wants: To finish his self-portrait and live forever.
Where: Usually Undercroft, all day and night.

READ ALOUD

“On the train” *(Prologue)*

Only the Quill sees it: a painted eye opening under the cloth, following them.

Clue: The covered painting’s eyes follow a Quill

READ ALOUD

“Anyone who gets close” *(Day 1 onward)*

Cold air. The faint smell of turpentine. Something under the cloth breathes.

READ ALOUD

“The bargain (to one student, alone)” *(Day 5 onward)*

“You want to protect them. I know a curse that cannot be blocked, child. Prove you deserve it.”

Quest: The Painter’s Bargain

TIP

Send the rest privately by Owl Post.

READ ALOUD

“The question” *(Day 6 onward)*

“What would you give up to never lose again?” Any honest answer is accepted.

TIP

Then teach the Killing Curse from the Players tab. An owl from the painting goes automatically.